

SPRINT 1 / MARKET RESEARCH

The research moved from meal plans to availability.

We first heard different preferences about campus meal-plan formats. Later, focused interviews recorded what people found when dining information did not match the food or service available on arrival.

13 meal-plan response sheets, including one staff response	8 respondents preferred a dollar balance	5 respondents preferred set meals
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01 / EARLIER MEAL-PLAN FINDINGS

Flexibility and structure both mattered

The 13 meal-plan response sheets include one response from a staff member. Eight respondents preferred a dollar balance, while five preferred a set number of meals. In their comments, respondents tied a dollar balance to changing day-to-day spending; one respondent said set meals would be easier to track.

Other answers mentioned rollover, discounts, food variety, portion size, and being able to use a plan at different locations. These responses describe a small interview group, not a campus-wide estimate.

02 / FOCUSED AVAILABILITY INTERVIEWS

What people found on arrival

12 focused availability response sheets

The focused availability response sheets ask what people checked before leaving, what they found at arrival, and what happened when an item or service differed. The responses include cases with a clear cost in time or money, as well as substitutions with no added cost. Some respondents said the hours or menu they checked matched what they found; the group did not report a problem on every trip.

Empty grab-and-go case	One participant walked to the Union for pizza; the detour took about 25 minutes (packet p. 10).
Kitchen closed while the cafe was open	One participant ordered delivery to a lab for about \$18 and waited roughly 40 minutes (packet p. 12).
Sold-out ribs	One participant bought a snack for about \$6 more and waited until after class for a full meal (packet p. 9).

Other sheets describe sold-out soup, unavailable milk, and changed stations. People sometimes chose a substitute, skipped an item, or learned about the change from a sign or staff member only after they arrived.

FROM INTERVIEW EVIDENCE TO SCOPE

Five candidate needs

01	Real-Time Food Availability System	Show whether food items and dining stations are available, low in stock, or sold out.
02	Dining Hours and Service Status Tracker	Show separate kitchen and counter hours, temporary closures, equipment outages, and service changes.
03	Flexible Meal Plan with Rollover Balance	Carry unused funds into the next semester and make balances and spending easy to see.
04	Customizable Meal Plan Options	Offer dollar-balance, set-meal, or combined plan structures for different needs and budgets.
05	Campus Dining Alerts and Notifications	Notify students about sold-out items, equipment failures, or restocking problems.

RESEARCH-LED SCOPING DECISION

Real-Time Campus Dining Availability System

After comparing the five candidates with the availability interview evidence, the team selected a system that shows current item and station availability before students walk to a dining location. The packet points to repeated surprises and concrete effects such as substitutions, delays, and extra spending.

WHAT THESE INTERVIEWS CAN SHOW

These 12 response sheets document interview examples. They do not measure how often each problem occurs across campus, establish its campus-wide financial impact, or prove that a particular system is feasible or effective.

SOURCE PACKET AND PAGE RANGES

Source: campus-dining-phase-2-final.pdf. The packet contains five candidate ideas and the scoping decision on pages 1-2; 12 focused availability response sheets on pages 3-14; and 13 meal-plan response sheets on pages 16-22 and 24-29. The meal-plan responses include one staff respondent. In the source, "Phase 2" names the research round; it does not mean Sprint 2 has started.